



Growing Your Bones



Did you know that your bones are alive?
Although we may think of bones as non-living,
the bones in your skeleton are alive. They grow
and change as you age.

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A baby is born with 300 different bones.
As you grow, some of the bones grow together
(or fuse). By the time you are an adult, you
will only have 206 bones.

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When we get to about 25 years old, our bones
stop growing larger. But, they keep on building
new bone cells.

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What do bones do? Bones have three jobs.
They give your body its shape. They work with
your muscles and get you moving. They protect
your soft body parts and organs. If you didn't
have bones, you might float like a jelly fish.

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Even though bones are light, they are strong
because they can hold our body weight.
Bones are made up of a protein called
collagen and a mineral called calcium
phosphate.

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Bones work with our muscles as a team. Muscles attach to our bones, when you move your muscles, your bones will move too.

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The bones in your skull protect your brain, just a like a bike helmet does. Your rib-cage will protect your chest and your back, your heart and your lungs. Bones grow to act like a shield to protect you. So, go on and keep growing your bones!

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